

Pay Transparency Guide Legal Requirement for EMEA

A reusable guide for **(Company)** to prepare hiring, pay-equity, and job-description practices for evolving EU pay-transparency requirements.



Directive and phased implementation

The EU Pay Transparency Directive becomes effective on 7 June 2026. Member States are at different stages of finalising local implementation.

As a result, **(Company)**'s approach should follow a phased rollout aligned to country-specific requirements as they are confirmed.

This legislation is designed to promote equal pay and reduce gender pay gaps by requiring organisations to be more transparent about compensation and to provide greater pay-equity reporting.

While local legislation is being transposed by individual EU Member States, hiring ranges may be shared with candidates verbally upon request, and job titles and job descriptions should comply with gender-neutral language requirements.

Template use: Keep a country-by-country implementation tracker and have local legal and HR specialists validate the current requirements before publication or use. This guide is an adaptable operational template, not legal advice.

Evolving hiring processes

Prepare for pay transparency by moving away from broad requisitions that cover multiple grades and geographies.

To be proactive and prepare for implementation of the Directive, **(Company)** should move to a more targeted approach to hiring requisitions.

For roles posted in EU Member States, requisitions should be scoped to **one specific grade and one specific country**. For roles in non-EU Member States, requisitions should be scoped to **one specific country**, while allowing multi-grade flexibility where appropriate.

Implementation guardrails

- Confirm the country in scope before advertising a role.
- Confirm whether the role is limited to one grade under the applicable local approach.
- Use gender-neutral language in job titles and job descriptions.
- Monitor country-specific rules as local Directive transposition is finalised.

Impacted EU Member States

The EU consists of 27 countries. Apply this guide to the Member States in which **(Company)** has operations, and validate local requirements as they develop.

The following 13 Member States are identified in this template: Austria, Belgium, Denmark, Finland, France, Germany, Ireland, Italy, Netherlands, Poland, Portugal, Spain, and Sweden.

Job requisitions posted in applicable EU Member States should follow the single-country, single-grade model. Requisitions posted in other EMEA countries should follow the single-country model, subject to local practice and legal requirements.

Austria · France · Italy · Spain

Collective Bargaining Agreement (CBA) details may be required. Confirm applicable local legal and labour-agreement requirements before the role is published.

Other listed Member States

Maintain a local compliance check for each country and revise hiring-range and reporting practices as national rules are confirmed.

04

Italy and Poland

Local transposition can alter the timing and method of candidate compensation disclosure.

Italy · effective 13 August 2026

Under Italy's transposition of the EU Pay Transparency Directive, pay ranges and Collective Bargaining Agreement (CBA) details must appear directly in the job posting itself.

Poland

Unlike Italy, Poland's transposition requires hiring ranges to be disclosed to candidates before the interview stage, rather than published in the job posting itself.

Country rule: Treat local legislation as the controlling source. Review the applicable disclosure timing, medium, and content before each launch or material process change.

05

Discussing compensation with candidates

Use a consistent, compliant approach while local implementation remains in progress.

While local legislation is being finalised for each EU Member State, recruiters should verbally disclose hiring ranges to candidates upon request. There is no need to proactively share ranges unless local law requires it. Where written disclosure affects sourcing strategy, it may be permitted, subject to local legal guidance.

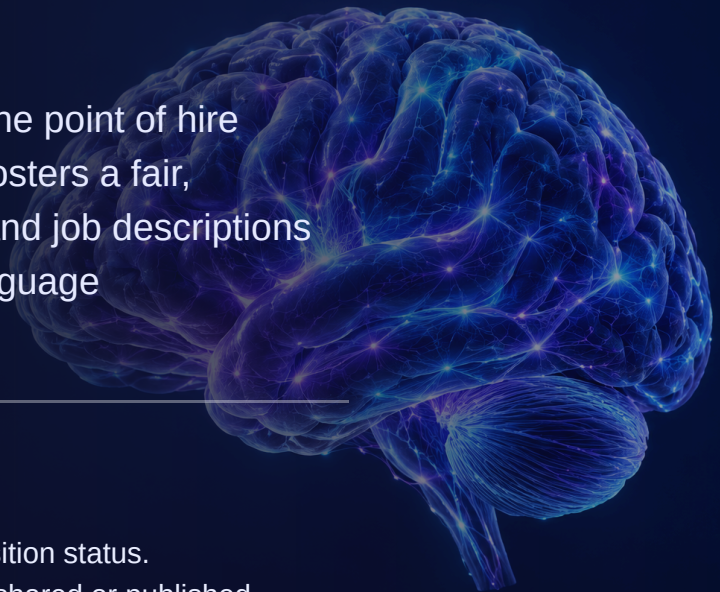
Approved hiring ranges should be obtained from **(Company)**'s authorised compensation resources. Recruiters must refrain from asking candidates about their prior salary history.

Candidate expectations versus compensation history

Recruiters may ask candidates about their compensation expectations, but not about their compensation history.

Pay equity and gender-neutral job content

Establishing equitable packages at the point of hire helps eliminate pay disparities and fosters a fair, transparent environment. Job titles and job descriptions must comply with gender-neutral language requirements.



Template completion checklist

- Confirm current local legislation and transposition status.
- Confirm whether and when a range must be shared or published.
- Confirm any CBA disclosure requirements.
- Review role scope, country scope, and grade scope.
- Use approved compensation resources and a documented pay-equity review process.
- Do not ask candidates about salary history.
- Provide leaders with clear, current guidance on the local approach.